

ARCHITECTURE OF GRACE

CASEL Five Competencies Crosswalk

CASEL's five core competencies, mapped to Architecture of Grace's four pillars — Identity, Self-Compassion, Forgiveness, Grace — and its five practiced moves. Then the part a one-page crosswalk usually leaves out: how each competency develops across the grade bands, and how the framework reaches all four of CASEL's settings rather than only the classroom.

The five competencies

CASEL competency	Grace move / pillar	What it looks like	What carries it
Self-Awareness	The Coach Voice · Identity	Naming feelings; separating a mistake from one's worth.	Book unit on identity; the Identity Audit (w1); the Perfectionism Spectrum (w5); the anchor chart that stays up.
Self-Management	The Pause · Release / Boundary	Regulating before reacting; letting go of what isn't theirs; holding a kind, firm boundary.	The Pause routine; Quiet Space and its pathways; the somatic floor materials; the Daily Check-In as a daily rehearsal, not a measurement.
Social Awareness	The Charitable Read	Extending the benefit of the doubt; reading others' feelings and perspectives.	Scenario card decks; the novels' cohort followed across five Rooms; the autism-adapted chart sets, which teach difference as design.
Relationship Skills	The Repair Move · Grace	Owning impact; moving toward repair; turning rupture into reconnection.	The five-step Repair Protocol; Talk It Out , the whole-class board; Rewriting the Script (w6); the Mistake Wall.
Responsible Decision-Making	Release / Boundary · Difficult-vs-Unsafe	Choosing a next step; telling "difficult" from "unsafe"; acting with care for self and others.	Values Under Pressure (w2); the Choice & Agency Map (w3); the difficult-versus-unsafe distinction taught explicitly as a skill.

The four settings · where the competency is practised

CASEL's framework is a set of concentric rings, and a curriculum that only reaches the innermost one is half a framework. Architecture of Grace has something in each.

Setting	What the framework puts there	Evidence it happened
Classroom	Six books K through adult; anchor charts as printable sets and as eleven live boards built with the class on the projector; scenario decks; worksheet packs; Talk It Out; Quiet Space; thirty interactive practice pages.	Daily Log; class trends; exit slips; probe records.

Setting	What the framework puts there	Evidence it happened
School	The MTSS report and its triangle; the adult team check-in, so a colleague who has the student for one period can answer honestly; the practitioner arc and the role Quick-Starts, including one written for MTSS coordinators.	Tier movement over time; school-wide and class-level reports; a colleague's observation, attributed.
Family	Matching Home Editions of every book; the Home Check-In across morning, afternoon and evening; home observations in the family's own words; the Family & adults tab; the parent-facing goal link.	Home observations beside classroom ones — the same skill, two environments, never averaged together.
Community	The mentoring band; Book 6, <i>The Dwelling</i> , which follows the same cohort into adult life; the Practitioner Edition pathway for adults doing the work themselves.	The adult record, kept on the same instrument in the same language.

How each competency develops · the grade-band arc

Competency	K–2 · Foundation	3–5 · Framework	6–8 · Interior	9–10 · Facade	11–12 & adult
Self-Awareness	Name the feeling out loud.	Notice the feeling before it moves you.	Tell the feeling from the story you told about it.	Notice the face you put on for other people.	Author the account of yourself.
Self-Management	A body that can be calmed, and one way to do it.	A Pause you choose, not one you are given.	Regulate under peer pressure.	Hold a boundary that costs you something.	Sustain it without an adult nearby.
Social Awareness	Other people feel things too.	The benefit of the doubt, offered on purpose.	Read a room you are not the centre of.	See the pressure other people are under.	Extend it to people who did not extend it to you.
Relationship Skills	Say sorry and mean it.	Repair, in five steps, rehearsed.	Repair when it is genuinely your fault.	Repair across a real rupture.	Repair as a professional practice.
Responsible Decision-Making	Safe and not safe.	Difficult and unsafe are different.	Choose the next step, not the whole road.	Decide when nobody is checking.	Decide for people who depend on you.

One thing this framework does not claim. CASEL's competencies are a map of what to teach. They are not a measurement scale, and the framework's three domains — Emotional Regulation & Well-Being, Self-Compassion & Growth Mindset, Social Competency & Repair — are not the five competencies renamed. They overlap; they are not the same object; and the instrument that measures the three has not been independently validated against the five, or against anything else. It is disclosed as such here and everywhere.

CASEL competency names are used for alignment reference; all descriptions and the grade-band language are Architecture of Grace's own. The framework is a Tier 1 universal SEL curriculum; its instrument layer is optional and the curriculum runs entirely without it. Review and adapt before submitting to a district. · **Architecture of Grace — SEL built by a teacher, for real classrooms.**